'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association

Fall 2018

CMA's New Property Manager

The Board has contracted with Almost Heaven Property Management (AHPM) to provide site management for CMA's common property. Because of their professional experience, we are able to depend on Holly Malcomb and Jason Schetrompf for many tasks that were previously performed by volunteers. The Board determined that the use of volunteers for some functions was unsustainable and often placed extraordinary burdens on members of our community. With the new contract in place, Almost Heaven Property Management will now manage CMA's common area property, to include:

- Roads - paving, gravel, grading, ditches, culverts
- Pool - oversee start up, shut down, seasonal management
- Barn - general upkeep and maintenance
- Sports courts - general upkeep, weeding, fences, nets
- Common property maintenance - mowing, signs
- Tree removal - blocked roads, common area hazards



If you see something that needs attention, please contact AHPM at almostheavenpm1@gmail.com or call or text them at (304) 671-0882 or (304) 676-3993. Please remember to identify yourself and leave contact information in case they need to respond to your request.

Please keep in mind that management of anything on a lot is the responsibility of the lot owner. This includes structures, driveways, trash bins, trees and water/sewer lines.

A big Thank You to Craig Deane, who has served as our site manager for several years. Craig will continue as the lead volunteer for our Sewer System. Thanks also go to Elmer Broxson (roads) and Bob Cohen (pool) for their fine work over many years. Certainly, our community is enriched by the good will and hard work of many of our neighbors. Board members, committee chairs and other volunteers provide immeasurable service - lending their talents and time to our community. If you'd like to get involved, please contact any committee chair, see "Committees & Contacts" on page 6.

Upcoming Events

Board of Directors Meeting	November 10, 2018, 10:00 am	CMA Office
Pot Luck Dinner	November 10, 2018, 6:30 pm	The Wohl's, E-4
Pot Luck Dinner	December 8, 2018, 6:30 pm	The Brydges, Q-4
Board of Directors Meeting	January 12, 2019, 10:00 am	CMA Office

Firewise Exceeds Annual Requirement

Firewise West Virginia is a state-level extension of the national Firewise USA program, which focuses on creating safe access and defensible space for homes built adjacent to woodlands.

Here are a few simple Firewise tips to help reduce your risk of fire:

- Remove dead leaves, pine needles, tree branches and combustible debris from around your home.
- Don't store firewood on or under porches or decks.
- Don't store gas-powered machinery like four-wheelers, lawn mowers and weedeaters under decks or porches.
- Plant less-flammable trees and shrubs around your home, including flowering dogwood, Eastern redbud, azaleas and hydrangeas.

Each year, CMA must document its Wildfire Risk Reduction Investment. At a minimum, we are required to invest the equivalent of one volunteer hour (valued at $24.14) per house in wildfire risk reduction actions. Residents completing certain home modifications and/or qualifying work at or around their home can contribute related hours and/or costs towards meeting our collective investment amount.

Again this year, CMA exceeded its minimum Risk Reduction Investment - thanks to the information provided from owners about work they completed on their property and work done by our site manager on common areas.

If you would like more information on how to protect your home and community from wildfires, please contact Cathy Levey, the CMA Firewise committee chair.

Volunteers are working on updating the CMA By Laws and Covenants & Restrictions. If you have suggestions, please contact Tom Holz.

Board Notes

- Over 40 owners attended the Annual Membership Meeting on September 8.
- Minutes of August Board meeting were approved posted to the CMA website.
- The 2019 budget was approved by membership with no increase in annual assessments.
- Elections were held at the Annual Meeting with the three members elected to the Board for two-year terms.
- After many years of volunteers running our water system, CMA has entered into a partnership with Warm Springs Public Service District to manage our water system. See information under Committee Reports, Water and Sewer.
- We have hired a property management team for the mountainside. Almost Heaven Property Management will be taking over the duties of Craig Deane along with the pool and roads.



Committee Reports

Our committees are run by dedicated community volunteers. If you'd like more information about a committee, please contact the committee lead ("Committees & Contacts" on page 6).

Communications

Are you getting email updates? If not, sign up to get CMA Listserv information in your inbox. Visit http://groups.google.com, search for "Coolfont" and select "CMA Members."

You can also join the CMA group on Facebook. Search Facebook Groups for "Coolfont Mountainside Association."

New directories will be distributed next year. Is your contact information up to date? If not, contact Cindy Van Meter.

DACC

Fall is a good time to take a look at the exterior of your home before winter. Are your gutters in good working order? Be sure to clear leaves and debris to avoid water damage and repair any loose or falling gutters or downspouts. In construction news, we have a new home being built in the community!

Finance

The 2019 budget was presented and approved by the membership at the Annual Meeting. There is no planned increased to annual assessments.

Please remember that assessments are due in January and late fees and interest will be applied to accounts that are not paid by January 31, 2019.

If you have questions about your assessment account, please contact the CMA bookkeeper, Brenda Close at 304-258-4742.

Firewise

Thank you to owners and volunteers who submitted information toward meeting our annual Risk Reduction Investment. As a reminder, you can submit this information anytime during the year. Please complete the Firewise Timesheet, available on the CMA website and send it to Cathy Levey.

Did You Know?

If you're planning to make a change to the exterior of your home, you must submit an application to the DACC for approval PRIOR to starting work.

Applications are available on the website and can be submitted by email.

Infrastructure

This new committee is working on identifying and documenting CMA resources such as components of the water and sewer systems.

Newsletter

Newsletters are planned for email distribution in February, May, August and November. The committee welcomes comments, photos and submissions for future issues.

Nominations/Elections

Thank you to Rusty McCrady and the committee for a successful annual election. Joan Claybrook and Cathy Van Metre were reelected to the board, and Tom Holz was elected. All will serve two-year terms beginning in January 2019.

Recreation – Pool and Trails

As part of their duties as Site Manager, Almost Heaven, will take over management of the pool next season. Thank you to Bob Cohen and Rusty McCrady for their hard work in keeping our pool going. Watch for information next spring about a volunteer clean-up day at the pool.

Roads

Almost Heaven is gathering bids for road work and repairs. If residents need work on their driveways, contact Holly Malcomb for information on how to obtain a separate bid from the contractor. Owners are responsible for costs for their own driveways.



Summer fun at the CMA pool!

Security/Neighborhood Watch

Volunteers keep our community safe by patrolling the community on weekdays and weekends during daytime and evenings. The security patrol volunteer vehicle is easy to spot, as they drive around the community with security signs on the sides of their car. Residents should report suspicious activity directly to the Sheriff's Office.

Social

Thank you to all the wonderful people who helped make the Annual Meeting and Dinner such a success: Cathy Levey, Leila Keese, Georgia Lohman, Jason and Sharon Geno, Craig Deane, Jason Schetrompf, Joanie Zuckerman, Marian Condon, Evelyn Brydges, Jackson and Sandy Bain, Kathy and Steve Katz, Lisa and Mark Johnson and Holly Malcomb. (Apologies if we missed anyone.)

Holly Malcomb will be planning new and exciting social events next year. She welcomes any help.

Technology – Website

The coolfontmountainside.com website contains a wealth of information for visitors and owners. Check out the owners' section where you'll find a Community Calendar, Services/Contractors and Owner Documents. Login info:

User ID: Owner Password: Coolfont

The Services/Contractors page lists local contractors that owners have used and recommend. These contractors are not endorsed by CMA. Under documents, you'll find the minutes of Board meetings, DACC and Firewise forms and the governing documents.





Water/Sewer

The water system's change to management and operation by Warm Springs Public Service District is awaiting approval by the West Virginia Public Service Commission, which gives permission for such management contracts. With PSC staff approval recommendations, we expect that order to come from Charleston in the next few weeks. When granted, the change from our amazing CMA resident volunteers operation to the professional team from WSPSD will take a few months, since our water system is complex and spread across a forested mountainside. But the result will be reliability, safety and our volunteer neighbors who won't have to go find system leaks in the middle of the night – in the woods!

The sewer system, as many of you know, has been successfully operated and managed by Warm Springs for over a year. Plans are in process to eventually divert our effluent from your septic tanks away from the lagoon-wetlands system and connect to the new CMA line being installed alongside Coolfont Resort's new connection to the Warm Springs sewage treatment system along Route 522. This will mean we can remove the lagoon and wetlands system. This will eliminate our clean water discharges into Sir John's Run and the related regulatory burden that creates for our community. For more info, contact Jackson Bain.

Annual Meeting/Dinner and Halloween Party















We'll Miss You

With a heavy heart, we say farewell to our friends who passed away this year. Our condolences to their families and friends.

- Harry Birnkrant passed away in early 2018. Harry and Myra bought their home at Coolfont (N-1) in the 1980's and loved coming here. In the early years, they visited often and Harry was active in CMA.
- Bob Borchers, owner of R-8, passed away in June 2018 at his home in Maui. Bob led the charge to bring CMA into the 20th century with our listserv and with his expertise in many other technology areas.
- Mary Kay Cloney, passed away in June 2018 following a 17-year battle with breast cancer. She was surrounded by her family in love and peace. Gordon and Mary Kay purchased K-6 in October 1999.
- Ron Glancz passed away in August 2018 after a 15-month struggle with an aggressive cancer. He loved the peaceful retreat that Coolfont. Ron and Margie bought "Cricket" (B-6) in 1979 – nearly 40 years ago.
- Rodney Pittman, youngest son of Carol Pittman, passed away in June 2018. The Pittmans live at the corner of Cold Run Valley Road and Route 9. Carol and her husband, Raymond, were fixtures on the mountainside for years helping CMA members with repairs, cleaning and monitoring their homes.



Committees & Contacts

Our committees are staffed by volunteers from the community and always welcome assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

Communications/ListServ - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com

DACC - Dennis Daisey
202-834-0180 dennis.daisey@gmail.com

Finance - Eileen Neely
559-476-9886 eileen@eileenneely.com

FireWise - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Infrastructure - Tom Holz
703-627-9391 tlholz@me.com

Newsletter - Dawne Holz & Liz Dane
703-362-6727 deholz@icloud.com
301-509-5209 liz.dane@verizon.net

Nominations/Elections - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

Recreation – Trails - Jason Geno
202-547-3304 jgeno@hciconsulting.net

Security/Neighborhood Watch - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Social - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Technology – Website - Jeff Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

Water & Sewer – Liaison - Jackson Bain
703-894-8035 jackson@bainpr.com

Water System - Joe Van Meter
703-532-6862 joevm1@yahoo.com

Sewer System - Craig Deane
301-964-4484 c.c.deane@gmail.com

Join the CMA Facebook group! Search Coolfont Mountainside Association in Facebook groups!